

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**WHY ?
&
HOW ?**



9th WEEK

25th February to 3rd March, 2019

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Commissioner**

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**Fraudulent Intent in
Repaying the Loan**

Learning Space

The President appointed Sushil Chandra as the new Election Commissioner.



Sunil Arora,
Chief Election Commissioner

SALIENT POINTS

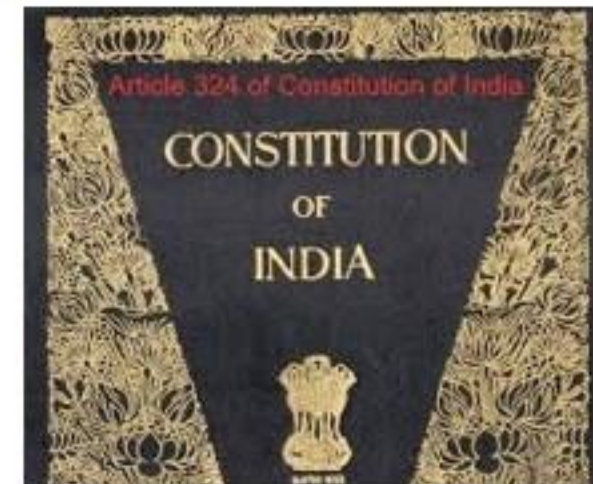
- He joins Chief Election Commissioner, Sunil Arora and Election Commissioner, Ashok Lavasa.
- It was made under Clause (2) of Article 324 of the Constitution.



Ashok Lavasa,
Election Commissioner



Sushil Chandra,
Election Commissioner





VARIOUS ISSUES PERTAINING TO ELECTION COMMISSION UNDER ARTICLE 324

1 The appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners shall be made by the President

... Hence appointment by the Executive.

2 The appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners shall, subject to the provisions of any law made in that behalf by Parliament.

... Law could not be enacted even after 68 years.

3 Removal of CEC just like that of the Judge of the Supreme Court.

... Appears to be OK.

4 Removal of the Election Commissioners on the recommendation of CEC.

... Provisions are not sufficient.



National Productivity Council celebrated National Productivity Week from February 12th to February 18th.



SALIENT POINTS

- The Theme is “Circular Economy for Productivity and Sustainability”.
- Circular economy is the one, in which economic development and environmental sustainability are interdependent.
- It's emphasis will be on minimizing pollution and maximizing reuse and recycling.
- Advantages of Circular Economy lies in not only increasing productivity, but also reducing carbon emissions, preserving valuable raw materials.

NATIONAL PRODUCTIVITY COUNCIL

- It is under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade.
- It is a tri-partite, autonomous, non-profit organization with equal representation from the Government, employers and workers' organizations.
- It is a constituent of the Tokyo-based Asian Productivity Organisation (APO), an Inter Governmental Body.
- It works towards accelerating productivity, enhancing competitiveness.



उद्योग संवर्धन और आंतरिक व्यापार विभाग
DEPARTMENT FOR
PROMOTION OF INDUSTRY AND
INTERNAL TRADE

CIRCULAR ECONOMY

- The present economy is “linear economy”.
- It revolves around “take, make, dispose” model of production.
- Circular economy focuses on long-lasting design, maintenance, repair, reuse, remanufacturing, refurbishing, recycling, and upcycling.



Australia officially declared “a Great Barrier Reef rodent extinct”, making it the first mammal believed to have been killed off by human-induced climate change.



SALIENT POINTS

The rat-like Bramble Cay Melomys, whose only known habitat was a small sandy island in far Northern Australia, has not been spotted in a decade.



WHAT ARE THE REASONS FOR ITS DISAPPEARANCE?



- It is due to the repeated ocean inundation of the Cay, over the last decade. It resulted in the dramatic habitat loss.
- It is the low lying island on a coral reef.
- It officially transferred the animal to the “Extinct list”.
- Human-induced climate change is the root cause for the loss of the Bramble Cay Melomys.
- It is considered as the Great Barrier Reef’s only endemic mammals species, which was first discovered in the Cay in the year 1845 by the Europeans, who shot the “large rats” for sport.

The Prime Minister inaugurated the National War Memorial near India Gate. It is built at a cost of Rs. 171 Cr.



A new Amar Jawan Jyoti was also inaugurated at the Memorial and the NWM will henceforth be the place for wreath laying for all designated events.

SALIENT POINTS

- It is constructed at the C hexagon near India Gate, to honour over 25,000 soldiers, who laid down their lives for the Country since Independence.
- A National War Museum has also been constructed at the Princess Park Complex Gate.

FEATURES OF NATIONAL WAR MEMORIAL



An Obelisk is a tall stone column with four sloping sides and a pointed top, made in honour of an important person or event.

- 1** It has 15.5 mt tall main obelisk with an eternal flame at the center. This is surrounded by four concentric circles ---
 - The Amar Chakra or Circle of Immortality.
 - The Veerta Chakra or Circle of Bravery.
 - The Tyag Chakra or Circle of Sacrifice.
 - The Rakshak Chakra or Circle of Protection.
- 2** The Tyag Chakra has 16 circular walls of honour, which bear the names of 25,942 soldiers written in gold on granite walls.
- 3** Statues of 21 Param Vir Chakra awardees have also been installed.

VIEW OF NATIONAL WAR MEMORIAL



HISTORY OF INDIA GATE

- India Gate was constructed by British in memory of 84,000 Indian soldiers killed fighting for the Empire in World War-I and the Afghan Campaign.
- The Amar Jawan Jyoti was built under its arch by the Indira Gandhi Government to honour the 3,843 soldiers, who died liberating Bangladesh in 1971.



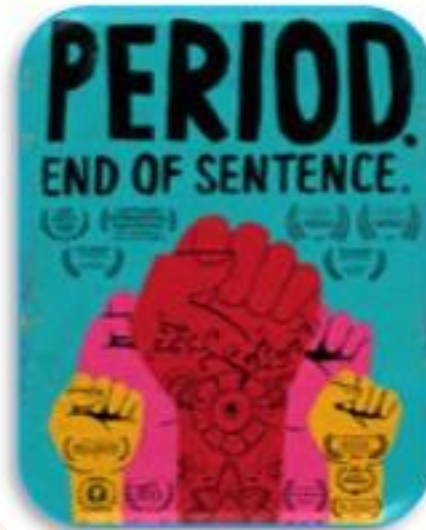
A film on Menstruation, set in rural India, titled “Period. End of Sentence”, has won the Oscar in the Documentary Short Subject category at the 91st Academy Awards.



RAYKA ZEHTABCHI

Director, Period. End of Sentence

Rayka Zehtabchi is an Iranian-American film director based in Los Angeles.



SALIENT POINTS

- Award winning filmmaker Rayka Zehtabchi has directed the short film.
- It is co-produced by Indian producer Guneet Monga's Sikhya Entertainment.
- It is part of The Pad Project, started by students at Oakwood School in Los Angeles and their teacher, Melissa Berton.

MORE ON THIS DOCUMENTARY



- 1 This documentary feature is set in Hapur village near Delhi. Here women led a quiet revolution as they fight against the deep rooted stigma of menstruation.

- 2 For generations, these women did not have access to sanitary pads, which led to health issues and girls dropping out from the schools.

- 3 When the sanitary pad vending machine is installed in the village, the women learned to manufacture and market their own pads, empowering their community. They name their brand as "FLY".

Government recently issued an Ordinance for Unregulated Deposits and also for fraudulently defaulting on regulated deposit schemes.

THREE TYPES OF OFFENCES

1. Running unregulated deposit schemes.
2. Fraudulent default in regulated deposit schemes.
3. Wrongfully inducing depositors to invest in unregulated deposit schemes by willingly falsifying the facts.



WHAT ABOUT THE PENALTIES?

- Accepting unregulated deposits will be punishable with imprisonment between 2 and 7 years, along with a fine ranging from Rs. 3 lakh to Rs. 10 lakh.
- Repeat offenders will be punished with imprisonment between 5 and 10 years, along with a fine ranging from Rs. 10 lakh to Rs. 5 Cr.

Most commercial banks in India are likely to select RBI's Repo Rate as the External Benchmark from April 1.



SALIENT POINTS

- This is expected to improve monetary transmission.
- Banks had four options ...
 - Repo Rate
 - 91-day T-bill
 - 182-day T-bill
 - Any other benchmark interest rate produced by the Financial Benchmarks India Private Limited.
- The bankers felt that the repo rate is the most stable one as compared to other options.
- MCLR is currently the benchmark for all the loan rates.
- Banks typically add a spread to MCLR, while pricing the loans for homes and automobiles.

BUT, THE BANKS ARE NOT HAPPY!



- 1 Banks have opposed the move to shift to a new external benchmark for loan pricing on the grounds that their cost of funds are not linked to these benchmarks.
- 2 Without fall in the costs, it would not be possible to change the rates.

Central Bank is keen to see the new regime kicks-in!

The Government capped trade margins of 42 cancer drugs at 30%, expanding the span of price controls to curtail undue profiteering by chemists and drug stockists.



Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
Government of India



SALIENT POINTS

- Drug Price Regulator, National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority invoked Para 19 of Drug Price Control Order, 2013.
- This allows the Government to intervene in extraordinary circumstances in public interest.
- It notified a formula, for fixing MRP of 42 cancer drugs, restricting trade margin at 30%.
- It is likely to reduce prices of at least 72 medicine formulations sold under 355 different brands containing 42 drugs for which trade margin has been fixed.

President Muhammadu Buhari of Nigeria was re-elected.



MUHAMMADU BUHARI

President, Nigeria



ATIKU ABUBAKAR

Former Vice-President, Nigeria



SALIENT POINTS

- Mr. Buhari heads the ruling All Progressives Congress.
- He defeated former Vice President, Atiku Abubakar by about 4 million votes
- Unemployment is at present over 20%
- The countering of Islamist Boko Haram in northern part of the Country is still the work in progress.

POLL VIOLENCE IN NIGERIA IS NOT A GOOD SIGN!



***Ruling Party and the Opposition have
a duty to respect the rule of law.***

- 1** It is 20 years, since the Country returned to the democratic rule in 1999.
- 2** Recent elections suggest limited progress in the conduct of transparent elections compared to the previous decade.
- 3** Large number of poll related deaths in the last few days points to a disturbing absence of official accountability.
- 4** Peaceful election is one of the crucial indicators of credible transfer of power through ballot.

Infosys Limited said that, it has imposed a penalty of Rs. 9.50 lakh on its lead Independent Director, Kiran Mazumdar Shaw for “Inadvertent Trade” in the company stock, i.e., violative of the insider trading regulations.



KIRAN MAZUMDAR SHAW

Independent Director, Infosys Limited

Infosys

SALIENT POINTS

- It was mentioned that the trade was carried out by the portfolio manager without the knowledge of Kiran Mazumdar Shaw.
- In Portfolio Management Services, the investor does not generally monitor the day to day investment decisions.
- In this case also, Kiran Mazumdar Shaw has not given any instruction to conduct the trade.
- She also has no knowledge of the trade having occurred.
- The Portfolio Manager took the decision to conduct the trade and hence it is inadvertent trading.

The Prime Minister laid the foundation stone for the restoration of rail connectivity between Rameswaram and Dhanushkodi and the restoration works of the Pamban Bridge (bridge across Pamban viaduct).



SALIENT POINTS

- Rameswaram-Dhanushkodi line got damaged during 1964 disaster.
- The Prime Minister congratulated Vivekananda Kendra on being conferred the Gandhi Peace Prize, a few days ago.
- Train-18 is manufactured in Integral Coach Factory, Chennai and the Prime Minister also congratulated them.

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

KARNATAKA

TAMIL NADU

RAMESWARAM

PALK STRAIT

PALK BAY

ADAM'S BRIDGE

DHANUSHKODI

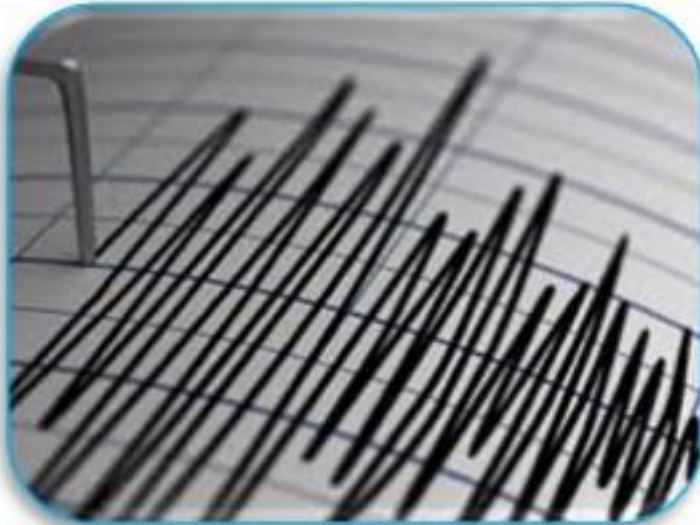
GULF OF MANNAR

Laccadive Sea

SRI LANKA



Palghar recorded magnitude 4.3 quake.



SALIENT POINTS

- Palghar district in Maharashtra, which has seen thousands of small earthquakes since November, 2018, experienced a quake measuring 4.3 on the Moment Magnitude (Mw) Scale.
- Moment Magnitude measures the size of events in terms of how much energy is released.
- This is the first time, the magnitude has crossed 4.
- Previously, it was thought, it is due to groundwater related activity.

HYDRO-SEISMICITY OR INTRA-PLATE TECTONIC ACTIVITY?

HYDRO-SEISMICITY

- Initially, seismologists believed that Palghar activity is due to hydro-seismicity.
- Here rainwater enters the existing faults in the Earth's crust.
- It increases pressure and subsequently, it is released through small earthquakes.
- In 2017, after heavy rains, some areas of Hyderabad experienced this phenomenon.
- Normally, they measure less than 4 Mw and subside by December.
- They will be very shallow, typically emerging from within 4 to 5 kms underground.

INTRA-PLATE TECTONIC FORCES

- Such a mechanism is believed to be behind 1993 Latur earthquake.
- Intra-plate tectonic forces could generate stresses along faults in Palghar.
- Now, the suspicion with regard to intra-plate tectonic forces is because of the reason that Palghar activity is continuing into February.
- Some of them originated from 15-km underground, deeper than most hydro-seismic quakes.

So therefore, the Country should be ready for disaster mitigation procedures.

598 **ISSUE**

The Supreme Court held that failure to repay a loan is not a criminal offence, unless there is a fraudulent intent.

**SALIENT POINTS**

- The ruling comes in the case of Satishchandra Ratanlal Shah versus the State of Gujarat.
- The mere inability of the appellant to return the loan amount cannot give rise to criminal prosecution for cheating, unless fraudulent or dishonest intention is shown right at the beginning of transaction.

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SINCERE THANKS
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